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Bringing state-of-the-art Gemini translation capabilities to Google Translate

Dec 12, 2025 · 4 min read

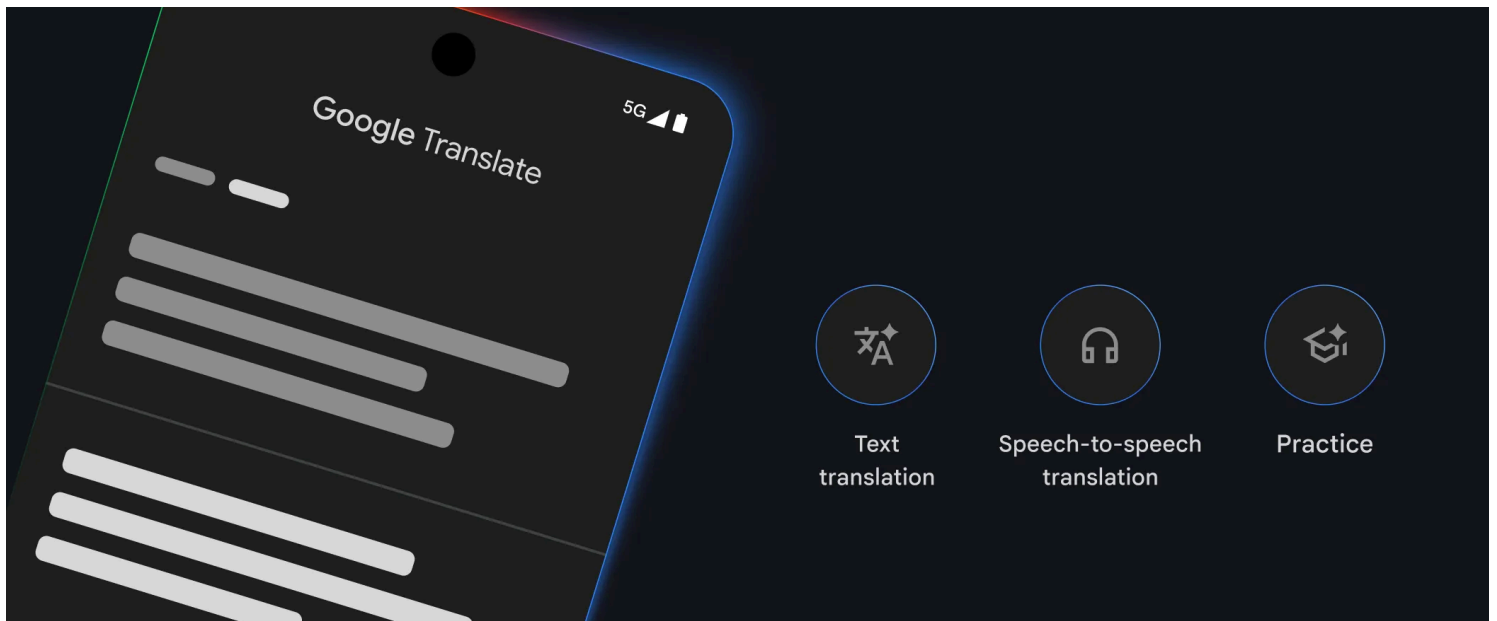
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We're bringing Gemini's most powerful translation capabilities to Google Translate for text, launching a beta experience for live speech-to-speech translations with headphones, and adding new languages to the app for practice and skill building.



Rose Yao
VP, Product, Search

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4:08 minutes

True understanding comes from not just *what* someone says, but also the nuance of *how* they say it. Today, Google Translate is getting better at both.

We're introducing state-of-the-art text translation quality ¹ in Search and the Translate app, built with Gemini. This means you'll get much smarter, more natural and accurate text translations wherever you're searching. We're also rolling out a new beta version of live translation, that brings real-time, natural-sounding translations right to your headphones with the help of [Gemini's new, native speech-to-speech translation capabilities](#). Plus, we're adding more languages for you to practice in the Translate app.

Get smarter, more natural translations, built with Gemini

Starting today, Google Translate uses advanced Gemini capabilities to better improve translations on phrases with more nuanced meanings like idioms, local expressions or slang.

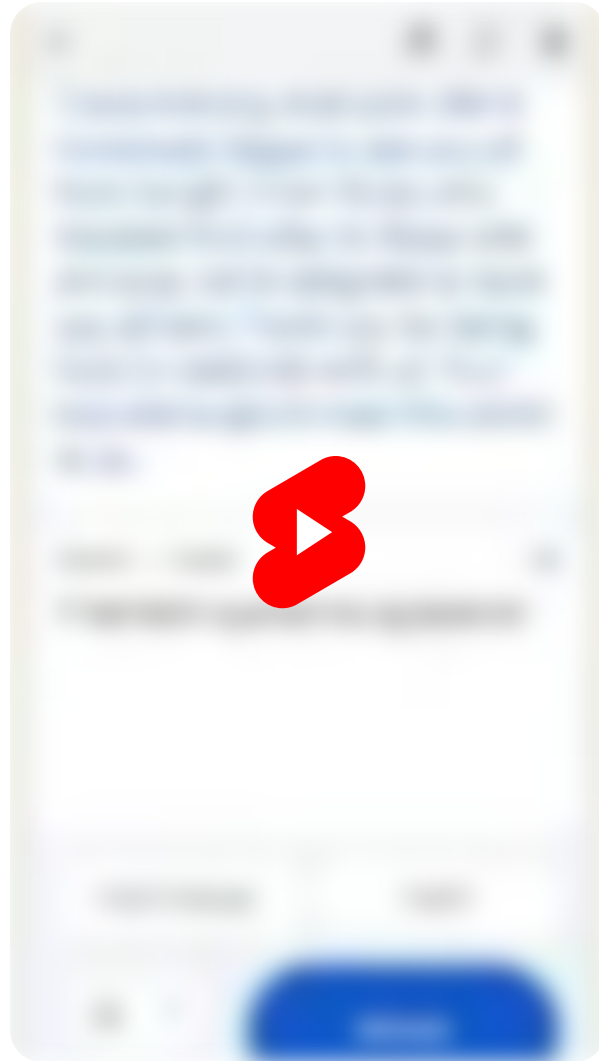
Say you're trying to translate an English idiom like "*stealing my thunder*." Now, it's easier than ever to get a more natural, accurate translation, instead of a literal word-for-word translation. Gemini parses the context to give you a helpful translation that captures what the idiom really means.



This update is rolling out starting today in the U.S. and India translating between English and nearly 20 languages, including Spanish, Hindi, Chinese, Japanese and German, in the Translate app ([Android](#) and [iOS](#)) and on the [web](#).

Hear and understand the world in real-time

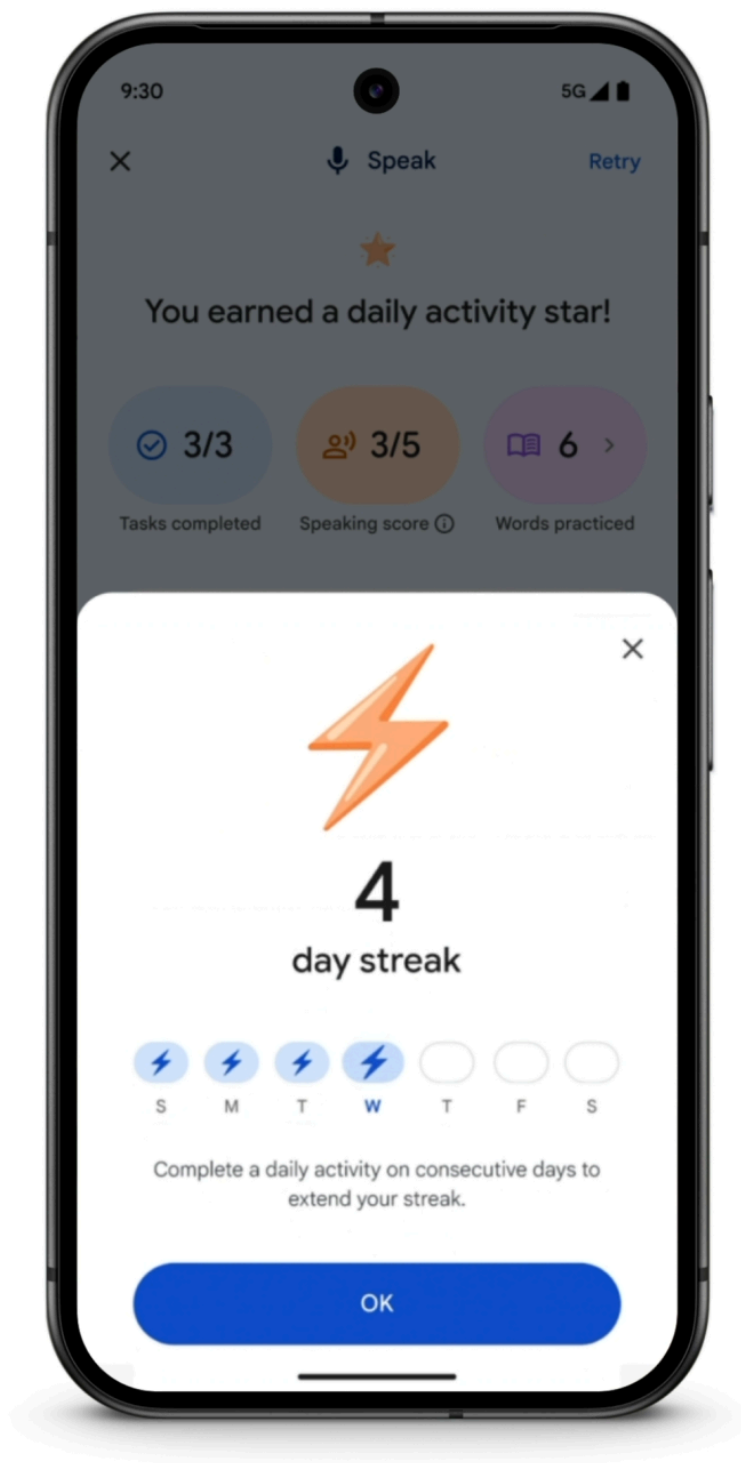
Building on [Gemini's new live speech-to-speech translation capabilities](#), we are rolling out a beta experience enabling you to hear real-time translations in your headphones. This new experience works to preserve the tone, emphasis and cadence of each speaker to create more natural translations and make it easier to follow along with who said what. Whether you're trying to have a conversation in a different language, listen to a speech or lecture while abroad, or watch a TV show or film in another language, you can now put in your headphones, open the Translate app, tap “Live translate” and hear a real-time translation in your preferred language.



Following positive feedback in early testing, we're excited to make this beta more broadly available to collect even more feedback as we work to refine the model and experience. Starting today the beta is rolling out in the Translate app on Android in the U.S., Mexico, and India, works with any pair of headphones, and supports more than [70 languages](#). And we'll be bringing it to iOS and more countries in 2026. Try it out in the Android app and let us know your thoughts via in-app feedback!

Practice and master even more languages in Translate

Starting today, we're also expanding our [language learning](#) tools in the Translate app with improved feedback so you can get helpful tips based on your speaking practice. We're also introducing a way for you to challenge yourself and reach your learning goals by tracking how many days in a row you've been learning, so you can clearly see your progress and consistency over time.



And we're expanding the capability to nearly 20 new countries including Germany, India, Sweden, and Taiwan, so even more people can continue to refine their language skills, including:

- English to German and Portuguese

- Bengali, Mandarin Chinese (Simplified), Dutch, German, Hindi, Italian, Romanian, and Swedish to English



We've heard from users that they appreciate the customized learning experiences that reflect real-life scenarios. We'll continue to add new ways for people to make progress on their language learning goals.

With even more advanced AI models and expanded language learning capabilities in Translate, we're helping you capture not just the words, but the meaning behind them. We're excited to *hear* what you think.

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